

Vertical & Horizontal Curriculum Map

MYP English A: Language and Literature | Years 6-10

Original planning cycle: 2021-2022 | Portfolio edition: 2026

A cross-grade planning artifact that aligns concepts, global contexts, texts, assessments, MYP criteria, skill development, and transfer opportunities across 20 planned units.

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About this sample

This curriculum map began as a collaborative planning document for IB Middle Years Programme English A. I contributed to the vertical and horizontal alignment process and incorporated feedback from colleagues, programme coordinators, and students.

Portfolio note: This edition improves organization, readability, wording, and title consistency while retaining the source plan's instructional decisions. Incomplete source fields are labeled rather than invented, and school identifiers are omitted.

What the artifact demonstrates

- Horizontal alignment within each unit: concepts, contexts, texts, assessments, criteria, and transfer links work as one planning system.
- Vertical alignment across year groups: recurring skills such as citation, intertextuality, connotation, comparison, and essay structure increase in complexity.
- Assessment variety: students create analytical, creative, oral, visual, and digital products for different audiences and purposes.
- Interdisciplinary transfer: Theory of Knowledge (TOK), Creativity-Activity-Service (CAS), learner profile, and Diploma Programme readiness are built into the map.

Vertical progression snapshot

Planning sequence	Connotation	Citation	Intertextuality	Argument / structure	Global connections
Y6 (MYP 1)	Level 1	Introduction	Connections / allegory	PEEL introduction	Level 1
Y7/Y8 (MYP 3) - 1	Level 2	-	Level 2	PEEL 2	Level 2
Y7/Y8 (MYP 3) - 2	Levels 3-4	Levels 2-3	-	PEEL 3 / transitions	Levels 3-4
Y9/Y10 (MYP 5) - 1	Level 5	Level 4	Level 3	Essay structures 1-2	Level 5
Y9/Y10 (MYP 5) - 2	-	-	Level 4	Essay structures 3 / lenses	Context and purpose

Note: Level numbers reproduce the progression markers used in the source plan; a dash means the skill was not explicitly labeled in that sequence.

Year 6 (MYP 1)

Horizontal unit alignment across one academic year | Planned class sessions: 17 / 25 / 21 / 25

Alignment element	Unit 1	Unit 2	Unit 3	Unit 4
Genre	Family fiction / drama	Folk Literature	Non-fiction	Fantasy
Key / Related Concepts	Connections Character / context / setting	Creativity Self-expression / intertextuality	Communication Audience imperatives / genres / purpose	Perspective Point of view / purpose
Global Context	Identities and relationships Identity formation	Orientation in space and time Exchange and interaction	Personal and cultural expression Social constructions of reality, philosophies and ways of life	Globalization and Sustainability Commonality
Texts	Key text: <i>Wonder</i> by R.J. Palacio Supporting: Seedfolks by Paul Fleischman; Mother and Daughter by Gary Soto (short story); What Maisie Knew (film); Aha! Parenting (blog)	Key text: <i>The Alchemist</i> by Paulo Coelho Supporting: The New Windmill Book of Stories from Around the World by Hilary Patel; Fairy Tales from the Brothers Grimm by Philip Pullman; The Elephant and the flies (Chinese folk literature); Assorted Folk Tales	Key text: <i>Born a Crime</i> by Trevor Noah Supporting: Olaudah Equiano autobiography	Key text: <i>Redwall</i> by Brian Jacques Supporting: Student Choice; Alice in Wonderland by Lewis Carroll; The Lion the Witch and the Wardrobe by C.S. Lewis; Fellowship of the Ring by J.R.R. Tolkien
Statement of Inquiry	A change in perspective changes meaning.	Authors creatively use intertextuality to exhibit exchange and interaction for self-expression	A true story can never offer a complete account of an event.	<i>Not documented in source plan</i>
Summative Assessment	Create an informative eBook exploring family structures and experiences.	Write an original story using common features of folk literature.	Deliver a speech based on a personal story.	Design an original outdoor game or sport.
MYP Assessment Criteria	A; B	C; D	B; C	A; D
Approaches to Learning	Research. Information literacy skills. Finding, interpreting, judging and creating information. Collect and analyze data to identify solutions and make informed decisions Thinking. Critical thinking skills. Analyzing and evaluating issues and ideas. Identify obstacles and challenges.	Communication. Communication skills. Exchanging thoughts, messages and information effectively through interaction. Give and receive meaningful feedback. Thinking. Creative thinking skills. Generating novel ideas and considering new perspectives. Create original works and ideas; use existing works and ideas in new ways.	Social. Collaboration skills. Working effectively with others. Listen actively to other perspectives and ideas. Thinking. Critical thinking skills. Analyzing and evaluating issues and ideas. Draw reasonable conclusions and generalizations.	Research. Media literacy skills. Interacting with media to use and create ideas and information. Seek a range of perspectives and multiple and varied sources. Thinking. Transfer skills. Using skills and knowledge in multiple contexts. Inquire in different contexts to gain a different perspective.
Learner Profile	Inquirers, Thinkers	Open-minded	Balanced	Risk-takers
Skill Progression	- Create an online survey and collect data - Interpret survey data - Headings & subheadings - Word connotations 1	- Venn diagram: Compare and contrast - Writing for an audience and purpose - Allegories - Folk literature genre	- Global issues connections 1 - PEEL - Introduction to citation - Rhetorical devices 1	- Allegories 2 - Intertextuality - connections - Analogies - Fantasy genre
TOK Connection	Where does your notion of ‘family’ come from? What is it and how do you know?	How big of a role does your memory play in constructing things you know and why?	What is something you have learned is true from your experiences? Do you think what you learned is true for everyone?	How does imagination help to create knowledge? How important is knowledge from imagination? If possible, use an example from the key text.
CAS / Service Connection	Identify a creative act of service within our key text and write a paragraph reflection.	Build a new peer connection by sharing and listening to personal stories, then reflect on the experience.	Plan and execute a way to develop your learner profile attribute of ‘communication’ in a way that you feel can help you to improve. Write a short reflection about it.	Use imaginative questions to facilitate a positive peer discussion, then write a short reflection.

Years 7/8 (MYP 3) - Sequence 1

Horizontal unit alignment; source sequence label (1) retained

Alignment element	Unit 1	Unit 2	Unit 3	Unit 4
Genre	Graphic Novels	Song Lyrics	Love and Romance	Adventure Survival
Key / Related Concepts	Creativity Setting / character	Perspective Theme / self-expression	Connections Point of view / intertextuality	Communication Context / purpose
Global Context	Identities and Relationships Status	Fairness and Development Justice and conflict	Scientific and Technical Innovation Adaptation	Globalization and Sustainability Human impact on environment
Texts	Key text: <i>American Born Chinese</i> by Gene Luen Yang Supporting: <i>Dracula</i> by Bram Stoker (graphic novel); Film: <i>Spider-Man: Into the Spider-Verse</i> ; Popular Meme Templates	Key text: <i>Song Lyrics on social justice</i> Supporting: Social justice speeches (e.g., 'I Have a Dream'); Social justice images/political cartoons	Key text: <i>The Bird and the Blade</i> by Megan Bannen Supporting: <i>The Sound of Waves</i> by Yukio Mishima; <i>Romeo and Juliet</i> by William Shakespeare	Key text: <i>Hatchet</i> by Gary Paulsen Supporting: <i>Into the Wild</i> by Jon Krakauer; <i>Life of Pi</i> by Yann Martel; Wilderness survival guide; Life raft survival guide
Unit Title	Introduction to Comic Style Literature	Risky Activism	Expressions of Love	Nature and Survival
Summative Assessment	Create a comic	Create an infographic	Create a blog	Create an informative survival video
MYP Assessment Criteria	C; B	A; D	A; B	C; D
Learner Profile	Open-minded	Risk-takers	Caring; Communicators	Thinkers
Skill Progression	- Graphic novel vocabulary - Graphic novel styles - Graphic novel techniques	- Verses - Rhyming - Audience impact	- Symbolism 1 - Intertextuality 2 - PEEL 2 - Word connotations 2	- Global issue connections 2 - Non-literary text connections 1
TOK Connection	What social and cultural influences shape racial identity? How do people come to understand their own identities?	Identify assumptions in a text of your choosing.	What is love? Where did you get that understanding?	How important is shared knowledge in the sciences? What happens when science is based on personal knowledge?
CAS / Service Connection	Create a positive visual message that reinforces a school value.	Adapt lyrics from a familiar song to communicate a social justice message for an appropriate school audience.	Plan and carry out a peer-led kindness initiative, then reflect on its impact.	Create a survival video to educate travelers wanting to go to some remote area of the country where you reside.

Years 7/8 (MYP 3) - Sequence 2

Horizontal unit alignment; source sequence label (2) retained

Alignment element	Unit 1	Unit 2	Unit 3	Unit 4
Genre	Graphic Novels	Dystopian Literature	Science fiction	Historical fiction coming of age
Key / Related Concepts	Creativity Perspective / genre	Perspective Purpose / theme	Communication Intertextuality / audience imperatives	Perspective Structure / setting
Global Context	Identities and Relationships Human dignity	Scientific and Technical Innovation Risk	Globalization and Sustainability Interconnection	Orientation in Time and Space Turning points
Texts	Key text: <i>Maus by Art Spiegelman</i> Supporting: Anne Frank (autobiography); Photos of Nazi Germany	Key text: <i>Fahrenheit 451 by Ray Bradbury</i> Supporting: The Giver by Lois Lowry; Film: Equilibrium; Film: The Giver	Key text: <i>Ender’s Game by Orson Scott Card</i> Supporting: Dune by Frank Herbert	Key text: <i>The Kite Runner by Khaled Hosseini</i> Supporting: New York Times news articles on the War in Afghanistan
Unit Title	Power and Problems	Dystopian Literature Basics	<i>Not documented in source plan</i>	<i>Not documented in source plan</i>
Summative Assessment	Opinion Essay	Create an informative podcast	<i>Not documented in source plan</i>	<i>Not documented in source plan</i>
MYP Assessment Criteria	C; D	A; B	<i>Not documented in source plan</i>	<i>Not documented in source plan</i>
Skill Progression	- Non-literary text connections 2 - Global issues connections 3 - Citations 2 - Graphic novel genre	- Author’s intention - Symbolism 2 - Introduction to dystopian lit - Word connotations 3 - Dystopian genre	- Citations 3 (in-text) - Compare and contrast 2 - PEEL 3 - Word connotations 3 - Science fiction genre	- Non-literary text connections 3 - Global issues connections 4 - Transition sentences 1 - Word connotations 4
TOK Connection	How do emotions help to construct knowledge?	What do you know based on intuition?	In what ways do events in our key text conflict with something you know is true. Be prepared to explain how you know.	Identify an assumption from our key text. Find an example of personal knowledge colored by personal perspective.
CAS / Service Connection	Create a positive visual message that reinforces a school value.	Help classmates identify an area of needed growth and how they can develop the risk-taker learner profile attribute, then hold each other accountable in carrying out an action.	Research how the school currently deals with local pests such as snakes, cockroaches, rats, stray cats, spiders, mosquitos, etc., the plan and present a friendlier, healthier alternative way to treat the issue.	Research schools or organizations in Afghanistan or another country and coordinate with them in a collaborative activity or campaign or exchange.

Years 9/10 (MYP 5) - Sequence 1

Horizontal unit alignment; source sequence label (1) retained

Alignment element	Unit 1	Unit 2	Unit 3	Unit 4
Genre	Mystery	Plays	Adventure	Science Fiction
Key / Related Concepts	Connections Style / genre	Creativity Structure / style	Connections Character / context	Communication Point of view / audience imperatives
Global Context	Orientation in Space and Time Constraints and adaptation	Personal and Cultural Expression Ways of life	Fairness and Development Justice	Scientific and Technical Innovation Ethics
Texts	Key text: <i>Sherlock Holmes by Sir Arthur Conan Doyle</i> Supporting: One of Us Is Lying by Karen M. McManus; The Curious Incident of the Dog in the Night-Time by Mark Haddon	Key text: <i>Aminata by Francis Imbuga</i> Supporting: A Doll’s House by Henrik Ibsen; Spring Awakening by Frank Wedekind; Short Scripts	Key text: <i>The Count of Monte Cristo by Alexandre Dumas</i> Supporting: Two in One by Mwangi Ruheni; The Memory of Running by Ron McLarty	Key text: <i>Feed by M.T. Anderson</i> Supporting: The Three-Body Problem by Liu Cixin; TV: Black Mirror: White Christmas; Coca-Cola Advertisements
Unit Title	Mystery Literature	Language of Scripts	<i>Not documented in source plan</i>	<i>Not documented in source plan</i>
Summative Assessment	Murder Mystery Game	Script Writing	<i>Not documented in source plan</i>	<i>Not documented in source plan</i>
Skill Progression	- Intertextuality 3 - Audience targeting - Identifying Genre features - Word connotations 5	- Stage instructions - Play Vocabulary - Narration	- Global issues connections 5 - Essay structures 1 - Citations 4	- Compare and contrast 3 - Essay structures 2 - Visual rhetoric
TOK Connection	How is reason used to construct knowledge in our key text? How is deduction used to construct knowledge in our key text?	How is language used to present knowledge in our key text? Provide an example.	What is justice? Where does your understanding of justice come from? Give an example of justice from the news.	Find an example of personal knowledge in our key text which you believe is colored by personal perspective.
CAS / Service Connection	Students can inspect the safety of our school grounds and identify possible low-cost improvements to safety, then pitch the changes to the head of school.	Invite and encourage peers to contribute their acting talents, then reflect on how your support affected participation.	Research anti-bullying techniques and educate younger students on how to defend against and respond to bullying.	Review technology usage at the school and identify areas where the school can balance technology usage with more active and natural alternatives.

Years 9/10 (MYP 5) - Sequence 2

Horizontal unit alignment; source sequence label (2) retained

Alignment element	Unit 1	Unit 2	Unit 3	Unit 4
Genre	Poetry	African-American Literature Feminist Literature	Short Stories	Post-colonial Literature
Key / Related Concepts	Creativity Context / self-expression / structure	Perspective Genre / Audience imperatives	Communication Character / point of view	Perspective Structure / style
Global Context	Personal and cultural expression Artistry, craft, creation, beauty	Fairness and Development freedom	Identities and Relationships Consciousness and mind	Globalization and Sustainability diversity
Texts	Key text: <i>The House on Mango Street</i> by Sandra Cisneros Supporting: The Fat Black Woman's Poems by Grace Nichols; Poetry: Student Choice; Teacher-selected Individual Poems/Lyrics	Key text: <i>Their Eyes Were Watching God</i> by Zora Neale Hurston Supporting: Foreign Soil by Maxine Beneba Clarke	Key text: <i>An Occurrence at Owl Creek Bridge</i> by Ambrose Bierce Supporting: Harrison Bergeron by Kurt Vonnegut; The Yellow Wallpaper by Charlotte Perkins Gilman; The Story of an Hour by Kate Chopin; Foreign Soil by Maxine Beneba Clarke	Key text: <i>Things Fall Apart</i> by Chinua Achebe Supporting: Carcase for Hounds by Meja Mwangi; Flatland by Edwin A. Abbott; Antigone by Sophocles
Unit Title	Personal and Cultural Expression through Poetry	Freedom and Expectations	<i>Not documented in source plan</i>	<i>Not documented in source plan</i>
Summative Assessment	Poetry Portfolio	Individual oral assessment (IO)	MYP eAssessment preparation	Essay
MYP Assessment Criteria	A; B	C; D	C; D	A; B
Skill Progression	- Stanza - Poetic devices - Form and function - Rhyming 2	- Literary theory lenses - Intertextuality 4 - Essay structures 3 (whole-essay organization) - Compare and contrast contexts	- Form and function 2 - Historical context - Author intent	- Symbolism 3 - Author intent 2 - Compare and contrast purpose - Post-Colonial Genre
TOK Connection	How is language used to communicate knowledge?	How do the character’s values convey cultural knowledge in our key text?	How does social practice contribute to knowledge? Give an example from one of our key texts.	How does power influence the construction of knowledge? Give a real example or one from our key text.
CAS / Service Connection	Host a poetry slam in the school theater after lunch.	Raise awareness for a cause that impacts a minority population.	Make a plan to strengthen or empower student voice at our school.	Participate in an act of service for someone at our school who is not in a position of power.